

EDWARD J. CARTER

Data Platform Strategy & Modernization | Enterprise Data Architecture | Engineering Leadership

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Data platform and engineering leader operating at the intersection of architecture, strategy, and organizational enablement across defense, intelligence, and commercial environments. Defines and advances platform strategy, governance models, and engineering standards that scale across teams, missions, and enterprise data ecosystems.

Known for modernizing distributed data platforms, aligning technical execution with organizational priorities, and enabling reliable, governed, real-time data access for mission-critical decision-making. Brings 20+ years of progressive leadership experience spanning military and commercial environments, with a focus on building adaptable teams, shaping technical direction, and delivering enterprise-level outcomes that extend beyond individual systems.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Data Platform Strategy & Modernization:** Enterprise data architecture, platform transformation, distributed systems design, modernization of legacy environments
- **Engineering Leadership & Organizational Enablement:** Cross-functional alignment, team development, stakeholder engagement, scalable engineering practices
- **Data Governance & Standards:** Data lifecycle management, data quality frameworks, governance models, ingestion and transformation standards
- **Distributed Data Systems & Real-Time Processing:** High-volume pipelines, streaming architectures, scalable processing frameworks
- **Cloud & Platform Engineering:** Kubernetes, containerization, AWS-aligned environments, scalable infrastructure design
- **Data Modeling & Analytics Enablement:** Data warehousing, semantic modeling, analysis-ready datasets, decision-support systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer, Platform & Data Engineering

Dec 2023 – Present

Ennoble First | SAFFIRE / CHINOOK

- Define and advance enterprise data platform capabilities supporting distributed processing, governed data access, and scalable analytics across engineering and mission teams.
- Establish data engineering standards for ingestion, transformation, validation, and lifecycle management, improving reliability and reducing organizational rework across teams.
- Lead evolution of medallion-based architecture patterns, enabling consistent data lifecycle management and scalable consumption across multiple teams.
- Drive cross-functional alignment across engineering, architecture, operations, and leadership, translating requirements into scalable platform capabilities supporting mission and organizational objectives.
- Improve accessibility, consistency, and trust in enterprise data, enabling more reliable and timely decision-making across engineering and mission stakeholders.
- Influence proposal and capture efforts by shaping technical solution approaches and validating feasibility aligned to mission and business requirements.
- Contribute to development of reusable architectural patterns and technical frameworks that guide data platform modernization and distributed system design across the organization.

Software Engineer / Data Engineer

May 2021 – Dec 2023

Army Software Factory | Army Futures Command

- Led architecture and scaling of high-volume data pipelines processing 500M+ records, reducing processing time from 24 hours to 26 minutes and enabling near real-time, decision-critical data availability.
- Delivered curated, enterprise-grade datasets into mission-critical platforms (Army Vantage), improving data accessibility and operational visibility across engineering and leadership stakeholders.
- Drove modernization of fragmented data systems into unified, scalable architectures, increasing interoperability and enabling enterprise-wide data access.
- Partnered across engineering, operations, and product stakeholders to align data platform capabilities with mission objectives and long-term organizational priorities.

- Enabled adoption of scalable data engineering practices, improving reliability, consistency, and delivery velocity across teams.
- Delivered curated, enterprise-grade datasets into mission-critical platforms, improving data accessibility, operational visibility, and speed of decision-making across stakeholders.

Data Engineer

Apr 2021 – Sep 2022

Texas ProTax

- Designed and implemented data integration workflows across SQL and NoSQL systems, establishing scalable pipelines to support enterprise analytics and machine learning initiatives.
- Delivered analysis-ready datasets aligned with governance and modeling standards, improving data usability and accelerating downstream decision-making.
- Supported executive-level data initiatives through alignment of data architecture with business and operational priorities.

Digital Intelligence Systems Master Gunner

Mar 2017 – Apr 2021

United States Army

- Led integration and modernization of enterprise intelligence data platforms (DCGS-A CD2, Palantir-powered), aligning data architecture with mission-critical decision systems across operational units.
- Directed and coordinated cross-functional teams spanning analysts, engineers, and operational personnel, ensuring effective execution of data-driven mission objectives.
- Partnered with leadership and technical stakeholders to translate complex operational requirements into scalable data platform capabilities.
- Owned reliability, accuracy, and availability of mission-critical data systems, enabling consistent real-time decision support in high-pressure environments.
- Drove adoption of data governance standards and structured data practices, improving consistency and effectiveness across distributed teams and organizations.

Intelligence Analyst → Data Scientist → Data Architect

Sep 2002 – Apr 2024

United States Army

- Progressed through increasingly senior roles with responsibility for leading data-driven operations and aligning data capabilities with mission-critical decision-making across multiple organizational levels.
- Led and mentored personnel from enlisted through warrant officer ranks, enabling career progression, leadership development, and technical specialization across operational units.
- Developed and enabled cross-functional workforce capability by introducing technical training pathways, including industry-recognized certifications (e.g., CompTIA), expanding analytical and engineering skill sets across teams.
- Supported partner nation information sharing and interoperability efforts, mentoring international personnel and improving technical competency and collaboration across joint and multinational environments.
- Contributed to doctrine development and analyst training standards at the U.S. Army Intelligence Center of Excellence, influencing how data and intelligence workflows are executed across the force.
- Designed scalable data architectures and standardized analytical workflows, enabling consistent, repeatable, and reliable decision-support across distributed operational environments.
- Bridged analytics, engineering, and leadership stakeholders, translating operational needs into scalable data solutions aligned to organizational and mission objectives.

STRATEGIC IMPACT & CROSS-ORGANIZATIONAL LEADERSHIP

- Contribute to technical strategy, supporting white papers, RFIs, and proposal efforts across government and enterprise opportunities.
- Shape solution approaches spanning data architecture, AI/ML integration, and distributed systems aligned to organizational objectives.
- Act as a bridge between engineering, architecture, capture teams, and leadership stakeholders, ensuring technical direction is feasible, scalable, and aligned with mission and business goals.
- Influence engineering standards, governance practices, and architectural direction beyond direct project ownership, enabling consistency, scalability, and long-term platform sustainability.
- Contribute to development of technical narratives and strategic positioning that differentiate organizational capabilities in competitive environments.

TECHNICAL & PLATFORM EXPERTISE

- **Data Platforms & Processing:** Databricks, PySpark, ETL/ELT pipelines, medallion architecture, distributed data processing frameworks
- **Enterprise Data Systems:** Palantir (Army Vantage, DCGS-A CD2), large-scale analytics platforms, mission-critical data environments
- **Streaming & Messaging:** Apache Kafka, event-driven architectures, near real-time data processing
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS-aligned environments, Kubernetes, containerized workloads, scalable infrastructure design
- **Data Storage & Modeling:** PostgreSQL, NoSQL systems, data warehousing, semantic modeling, data lifecycle management
- **Languages & Development:** Python, SQL, distributed data application development

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Data Engineering
Auburn University

Expected 2027

Bachelor of Science, Database Management & Data Analytics
Western Governors University